

Legal Review & Escalation Guidelines

Defines when Legal review is mandatory and how contract disputes are escalated.

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Mandatory Legal Review Triggers

Legal must review a contract before signature whenever any of the following conditions apply. When in doubt, the business owner should request Legal review rather than proceed.

- Total contract value exceeds \$100,000.
- The contract deviates from an approved template or standard clause set.
- The agreement includes indemnities, uncapped liability, or unusual liability caps.
- The contract involves personal data, regulated data, or cross-border data transfer.
- The counterparty's own paper (their template) is being used instead of ours.
- The agreement includes exclusivity, non-compete, or intellectual property assignment.
- Any government, public-sector, or regulated-industry counterparty is involved.

Dispute Escalation Path

Where a disagreement arises during negotiation or during the life of a signed contract, the following escalation path applies. Each stage has a target response time.

Stage	Owner	Target Response
1. Contract owner attempts resolution	Business Owner	3 business days
2. Escalate to Legal Operations	Legal Operations	5 business days
3. Escalate to Head of Legal	Head of Legal	5 business days
4. Formal dispute / external counsel	General Counsel	As required

A dispute may not skip stages except where there is a risk of imminent financial or reputational harm, in which case it may be escalated directly to the Head of Legal.